FLE TRIBE

WEEK 16 · MONDAY · LESSON GUIDE

How hosting works

This week: Put your React apps online with Vercel: live links, environment variables, preview deployments and your own domain.

From code to website

- `npm run build` turns your React code into plain HTML, CSS and JavaScript in the `dist` folder.
- A host stores those files and sends them to anyone who visits your address.
- A **CDN** keeps copies in many cities, so your site loads fast everywhere.

Static hosting

A React app built with Vite is **static**: just files, no server code. That makes it cheap (often free) and fast to host on Vercel.

Check before you deploy

```
npm run build
npm run preview   # opens the production build locally
```

If it works in the preview, it will almost always work on Vercel.

Research questions

Answer these in the app, in your own words, to unlock the next lesson.

1. What's inside your `dist` folder after a build?
2. Why is a static site fast to serve around the world?

Start your research here

- MDN: https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Learn_web_development/Howto/Web_mechanics/What_is_a_web_server

- **Vite: deploying a static site**: https://vite.dev/guide/static-deploy